

Habib University Liberal Core Curriculum (Core 201)

Pakistan & Modern South Asia (PAMSA)



Fall 2024

Lead Instructors: Nauman Naqvi (Lead Instructor) & Najeeb Jan (Co-Lead)

Instructors: Nimra Farooq, Basharat Issa, Newal Osman, Asad Ur Rehman, Gabriel Mathias Soares, Sumbul Usman Yousuf,

Class Schedule: Monday Main Lecture 10:30 AM – 11:20 PM & Recitation Sections

Classroom Location: E215 Auditorium

Number of Course Credits: 4

Office Hours: Consult with your section leads

Hardware Prerequisites: A working, fully charged and reliable laptop or desktop computer

Software Prerequisites: Canvas, MS Office Suite or Google Docs, Acrobat Reader/Preview, (in case of quarantine: Zoom, Panopto)

Campus Safety Policy: Please familiarize yourself with and follow all campus safety policy and protocols whenever you are on campus to protect both yourself and others.

I: Course Description

The South Asian Subcontinent, home to one-fourth of the world's population, is a study in paradoxes. Culturally and spatially complex, religiously syncretic yet divisive, and politically tumultuous, the subcontinent is a diverse mix of languages, ethnicities, heterogeneous political and social regimes, and widely disparate economic, cultural, geographical and ecological habitats. Despite its recent emergence as a formidable regional and global economic and military power, India, much like Pakistan and the rest of South Asia, remains rife with contradictions, haunted by its colonial inheritance. Additionally today, both India and Pakistan are nuclear states – ones having already fought four wars since 1947. As the complex processes of globalization and technology break down the meaning of borders and nations, a knowledge of the multifaceted history and politics of this region has become critical to understanding our increasingly shared, violent and interconnected global horizons.

We begin this course on Pakistan and Modern South Asia by marking out the broad narrative contours around and often against which a variety of historiographical traditions have emerged; that is to say around a contested narrative history of the region. Our historical investigations will begin with the rise and fall of the Mughal Empire, before we turn to the formative and tumultuous period of modern British imperial rule. After exploring the complex effects both colonial power and the myriad responses to it, have had on the politics, cultures, economy and imagination of contemporary South Asian societies, we will turn to the independence struggle which culminated in the bloody partition of 1947. Apart from the main outlines of the history of modern South Asia, students will also learn to place the region's colonial modernity within the larger framework of modern history. Students will learn to identify major features of the colonial economy, politics and society under which – especially after the Great Rebellion of 1857 – regional religious and other social reform movements emerged, nationalisms formed, and the dramatic transformation of regional languages and traditions took place, processes that continue into the present.

This course will thus introduce students to the major thematics, personalities and events that constitute the history of Modern South Asia —British Imperialism/Colonialism, nationalism, partition, communalism, democracy, secularism, military rule and religious nationalism/populism. In particular we will be concerned with the phenomenon of nationalism itself. How did such a world-historical and transformative event – the emergence of the nation-state – come about? What has it meant for the peoples of this region? This question takes on a particular urgency in Pakistan as the region passes through the current period of crisis and change. With a significant focus on the emergence and trajectory of Indo-Muslim nationalism and the creation of Pakistan, this course will be a conspectus of the modern history of South Asia from the immediate pre-colonial historical scene, through the colonial period, including the rise of regional socio-religious reform movements, anti-colonial nationalism and formal decolonization, to the Cold War and the contemporary period of accelerated transformation and turmoil.

But most crucially, we will take up as a parallel subject of vital reflection, the question of “History” itself, by examining the complex ways in which the constructions of the past are bound up with issues of identity, power and the politics of the present. Hence we look at the ways in which “religion” (Islam vs. Hinduism) “caste” and “ethnicity” have been “framed” as the defining categories of South Asian history in both nationalist and popular discourses. Needless to say, we will be challenging the widely held thesis that South Asian history, and subsequently contemporary South Asian identities, revolve principally around a religious and ethnic axis. Hence one principle aim of the course will be to show how common-sense, but essentialist notions of ‘deep’ historical continuity and ‘timeless’ community, are in fact modern impositions.

How then have these notions of religious, communal and nationalist belonging been forged? To understand how our identities and cultures are constructed is to give us a critical distance and a

deeper historical understanding of what otherwise passes for “the natural,” “the given” and “common sense”. As such, students will learn to see contemporary conflicts, ideologies, identities and structures as specific to the modern period, rather than as natural cultural expressions, and they will begin to see regional cultures and societies themselves as historical entities. Our attempt shall thus be to understand “our shared globalized present” through serious philosophical, theoretical and historical thinking. In short, what is the history of our present – what is the genealogy of our regional modernity?

This course not only covers the historical trajectory of South Asian modern history, but also demands continual reflection on the significance of historiography – how history is represented and written – for a critical, historical understanding of ourselves in the modern world. The enterprise of history is not merely the presentation of chronological facts and figures – the recounting of what happened – but rather involves the critical evaluation of our cultural/historical memory, and an understanding of the transformative consequences of historical events. History is thus an interrogation of the very meaning and possibility of who we are as human beings.

II. Learning Outcomes:

- (1) Identify key moments in the trajectory of modern South Asian history over the past four centuries.
 - (2) Understanding and explaining historical change and transformation.
 - (3) Demonstrate the ability to think critically about historical representation and historiography.
 - (4) Present historical research and analysis effectively (both orally and visually) to an audience.
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III. Course Requirements

Texts, Readings & Videos

All texts will be available as downloadable PDF's from CANVAS (see Modules and/or Files, also see Modules for Reading Schedule)

The main texts comprising the course are:

Barbara D. Metcalf & Thomas R. Metcalf, *A Concise History of Modern India*, Third Edition (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2006)

Sugata Bose and Ayesha Jalal, *Modern South Asia: History, Culture, Political Economy*, Fifth Edition (New York: Routledge, 2004)

Selections from the following may also be used:

Faisal Devji, *Muslim Zion: Pakistan as a Political Idea* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 2013)

Other useful South Asian History textbooks include:

Ishita Banerjee-Dube, *A History of Modern India* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2014)

Burton Stein, *A History of India, 2nd edition* (West Sussex: Wiley-Blackwell, 2010 [1998])

Grading: Papers & Assignments

Like other classes in the Habib Liberal Core, the two key objectives of Core 201 are writing, critical thinking and engagement/participation. Thus, the grading scheme is as follows:

- (a) Papers: 35%**
Students will be given two essay/paper assignments during the semester. The first papers will be weighted at 15%. A second final comprehensive essay/paper question will be worth 20%.
Paper #1: 15%, 4 - 5 page paper (due end of Week 8/9, two weeks after prompt is handed out at end of Week 6)
Paper #2 Final: 15%, a more comprehensive/cummulative 6 page essay (due around the last week of classes, two weeks after prompt is handed out).
- (b) Midterm & Final Exam: 30%**
Both the midterm and final will be exam hall MCQ/fill-in-the-blanks style examinations with possibly a few short responses (handwritten). The Midterm will be held around Week 7/8 and weighted at 15%. The final exam will be cumulative but with an emphasis on the latter half of the course. The exam will be held in a specified examination hall and also weighted at 15%. The Midterm and Final will be designed largely to test your understanding retention of key ideas, significant dates and core concepts.
- (c) Quizzes & Short Assignments: 25%**
Brief in class Quizzes/Writing Assignments/Reflection based on readings and the main lectures, may be held in **each** recitation session and, at minimum, on a weekly basis (individual instructors may choose a variety of forms –short quizzes, written summaries or assignments). Quizzes/assignments will usually be held during the first 5 – 10 minutes of each recitation section. Quizzes are mainly designed to test that students have attended the main lectures and have at minimum completed their readings.
- (d) Attendance: 5%**
Attendance is crucial! Your attendance score will be the simple percentage of the number of classes you attended divided by the total number of classes held. RO excused absences will count only for a ¼ of an absence. Please note that you may be

automatically dropped from the class by the registrar if you have more than 4 unexcused/undocumented absences. So assuming a total of 45 sessions (including main lectures) if you have 2 excused absences and 4 unexcused absences your attendance score will be 39/45, which is 45 minus 0.5 for excused absences and 4 for unexcused absences).

- (e) **Participation: 5%**
see below
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IV. Attendance/Participation and Student Progress (formerly SEL)

Student progress and engagement will be measured through a combination of attendance and the timely completion of papers, assignments and quizzes. By week 4 or 5 the registrar/instructor will notify students who have not been regular in attendance (min 85% is required to pass the class) and/or have not completed quizzes/assignments.

Attendance is absolutely vital to the successful completion of the course. In person-presence is mandatory. Main lectures attendance WILL BE recorded (using enhanced biometrics). Once you enter the hall with biometrics, you cannot leave (except for urgent restroom use) so attendance at lectures is absolutely critical. If a student's attendance is less than 85% overall they will risk automatic withdrawal from the course, regardless of other metrics and at minimum severely reduced (or zero) points will be awarded for Attendance & Participation. So a minimum attendance is a prerequisite to pass the class (85%) and to get any A&P points. Poor attendance will, naturally, also negatively impact participation grades.

Students must check within a couple of days to see if their attendance has been noted in the biometric system or recorded by the instructor. If NOT they MUST inform the instructor within 3 - 4 days, to verify that they were in class/lecture. Students whose biometrics are not recorded, will not get attendance credit if they challenge their absence more than a week after the fact.

In order to get an excused absence, students must provide the registrar a medical or doctor's note, or provide valid strong reasons (death of immediate family member, accident, illness etc.).

Participation will be assessed in a similar manner to the traditional participation grade which is a subjective measure of the instructor's evaluation of the QUALITY of student participation and *attentiveness* in classroom discussions and other small assignments.

If the student regularly fails to attend in person classes and/or if the student regularly fails to submit required work (quizzes, written assignments, reflections etc.) or if the student leaves class early and comes into class late, these actions will compromise your participation grade. If a student's progress is assessed as insufficient, they may be reported to the RO. Students whose progress is deemed insufficient will be given a

warning and if the pattern continues through the midterm (and especially if no notice or explanation by the student for ‘absences’ or missed work is given) then the student may be advised to drop the class. In general a student should not WAIT to be informed of low scores, and should check assignment and attendance grades on Canvas as they are uploaded. Students should be present for all sessions and should be completing the required assignments for the course in a timely manner. Students are responsible at all times for monitoring their own metrics, grades and attendance scores. If your attendance approaches the 85% threshold , you must speak to your instructor otherwise the registrars automatic drop will remain in place.

Quizzes (MCQ or short written assignments) will be held **at least** once every week, during the first 5-10 minutes of each class. The main purpose of the quiz is to encourage students to read the assigned texts critically and carefully. The quiz questions will be *mainly* designed to test a very **basic** comprehension and retention of the significance and substance of the readings. There will be no make-up quiz for students who arrive late and or who are absent. The instructor may choose to drop one or two of your lowest quiz scores (or curve the cumulative point score). Students who have a **valid excused** absence may be allowed to complete the assignment later, take a make-up quiz or be given another assignment in lieu of the missed quiz/assignment, or the instructor may choose to allow the quiz to not count towards the final tally.

Grading Scale

GRADING SCALE		
LETTER GRADE	GPA POINTS	PERCENTAGE
A+	4.00	95 – 100
A	4.00	90 – 95
A-	3.67	85 – 90
B+	3.33	80 – 85
B	3.00	75 – 80
B-	2.67	70 – 75
C+	2.33	67 – 70
C	2.00	63 – 67
C-	1.67	60 – 63
F	0.00	0, 60

V. Academic Integrity

Each student in this course is expected to abide by the Habib University Student Honor Code of Academic Integrity. Any work submitted by a student in this course for academic credit will be the student's own work.

Scholastic dishonesty shall be considered a serious violation of these rules and regulations and is subject to strict disciplinary action as prescribed by Habib University regulations and policies. Scholastic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, cheating on exams, plagiarism on assignments, and collusion.

PLAGIARISM: Plagiarism is the act of taking the work created by another person or entity and presenting it as one's own for the purpose of personal gain or of obtaining academic credit. As per University policy, plagiarism includes the submission of or incorporation of the work of others without acknowledging its provenance or giving due credit according to established academic practices. This includes the submission of material that has been appropriated, bought, received as a gift, downloaded, or obtained by any other means. Students must not, unless they have been granted permission from all faculty members concerned, submit the same assignment or project for academic credit for different courses.

CHEATING: The term cheating shall refer to the use of, distribution, or obtaining of unauthorized information in order to obtain personal benefit or academic credit. Helping another student, or asking for help, with any form of exam or quiz, asking for or passing along answers either in person or electronically will be considered acts of cheating and a violations of your oath of academic honor and integrity.

COLLUSION: Collusion is the act of providing unauthorized assistance to one or more person or of not taking the appropriate precautions against doing so.

All violations of academic integrity will be immediately reported to the Student Conduct Office.

Any student violating academic integrity a second time in this course will receive a failing grade for the course, and additional disciplinary sanctions may be administered through the Conduct Office.

VI. Course Schedule

Important Note: Please consult the Canvas Main Course page for the current up-to-date readings and schedule for each week/module.

The lead instructors reserve the right to alter the reading schedule. If any changes are made students will be made aware of them well in advance of the reading due dates. The average reading load will usually average between 30 - 40 pages per week.

Students must come to class having read the readings assigned for their respective 1st and 2nd recitation sections (session A / B).

MODULE 1: PRE-COLONIAL AND EARLY MODERN SOUTH ASIA

MODULE 2: COLONIALISM & THE BRITISH IMPERIAL ORDER

MODULE 3: THE EMERGENCE OF NATIONALISM

MODULE 4: POSTCOLONIAL NATION STATES & THE COLONIAL PRESENT
